Ysbyty Gwynedd
Anaesthetics Department
Adran Anaestheteg

MANAGEMENT OF COMPLICATIONS

Dental Damage

YG CG 206 MARCH 2023

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Key Points

- Where possible, patients should be asked about dentition preoperatively, and counselled about the risk of dental damage where relevant.

If damage occurs:

- If patient in distress, pain relief and urgent referral to Maxillo-Facial services in YGC.
- If patient not in distress, refer to their own dentist. Request a report of the damage done, and an estimated cost of repair.
- Document fully, and complete DATIX report. Include DATIX reference on all correspondence.

Precautions

Prior to anaesthesia, the patient should be questioned about dentition, loose teeth, and dental work. If the anaesthetist feels that any aspect of the patient's dental history leads to an increased risk of damage while under general anaesthesia, this should be explained to the patient and documented.

If you become aware of any damage to teeth or dental work

Explain to the patient what has happened. Ensure that the patient is not in any pain or distress. Document this in the notes.

Examine the patient and document the condition of the teeth.

If dental damage is causing pain or distress, treat with appropriate analgesia and refer urgently to the maxillo-facial service, Ysbyty Glan Clwyd. Document this.

In all cases, fill in a DATIX form. Use the DATIX reference on all correspondence.

Should repair work be required, refer the patient to his or her own dentist and request in writing that they provide (a) a report of the damage done, and (b) an estimate of the cost of repair to be sent to the anaesthetic department. In most cases the department will then instruct the dentist to proceed, and to invoice the anaesthetic department directly. However, if the department feels that the cost is unreasonable, the department may choose to get a second opinion from another dental practitioner.